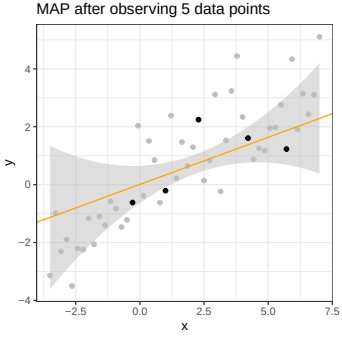
Introduction to Machine Learning

Gaussian Processes
Bayesian Linear Model

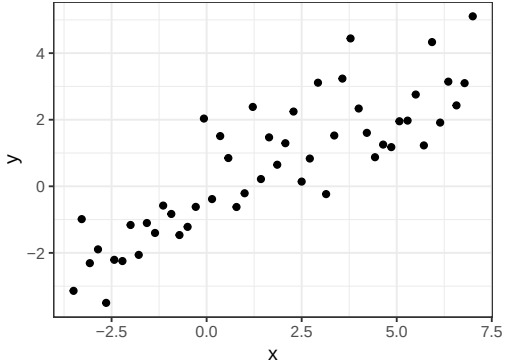


Learning goals

- Know the Bayesian linear model
- The Bayesian LM returns a (posterior) distribution instead of a point estimate
- Know how to derive the posterior distribution for a Bayesian LM

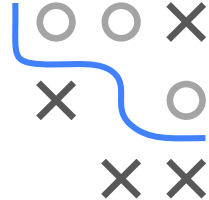
DATA SITUATION

- $\mathcal{D} = \left(\left(\mathbf{x}^{(1)}, y^{(1)}\right), \ldots, \left(\mathbf{x}^{(n)}, y^{(n)}\right)\right)$: i.i.d. training set from some unknown distribution



- $\mathbf{X} \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times p}$: design matrix, where i-th row contains vector $\mathbf{x}^{(i)}$
- $\mathbf{y} = \left(y^{(1)}, \ldots, y^{(n)}\right)^\top$

THE BAYESIAN LINEAR MODEL REVISITED



- Standard linear regression model for i-th observation, with $\boldsymbol{\theta} \in \mathbb{R}^p$ fixed but unknown

$$y^{(i)} = f\left(\mathbf{x}^{(i)}\right) + \epsilon^{(i)} = \boldsymbol{\theta}^T \mathbf{x}^{(i)} + \epsilon^{(i)}, \quad \text{for } i \in \{1, \ldots, n\}$$

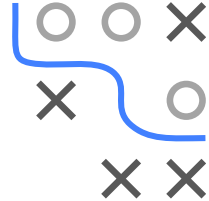
- Bayesian perspective: $\boldsymbol{\theta}$ = RV with associated distribution

- Function outputs $f\left(\mathbf{x}^{(i)}\right)$ differ from observed values $y^{(i)}$ by some additive noise assumed to be i.i.d. Gaussian

$$\epsilon^{(i)} \sim \mathcal{N}(0, \sigma^2) \quad \forall i$$

$\Rightarrow$ Independent of $\mathbf{x}, \boldsymbol{\theta}$

FROM PRIOR TO POSTERIOR



- Prior belief about parameter distribution, e.g., $\boldsymbol{\theta} \sim \mathcal{N}(\mathbf{0}, \tau^2 \boldsymbol{I}_p)$
- Bayes' rule: update prior to posterior belief after observing data

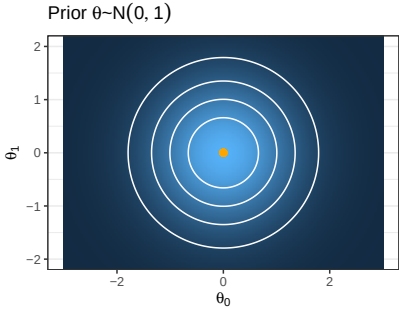
$$p(\boldsymbol{\theta}|\mathbf{X}, \mathbf{y}) = \frac{\text{likelihood} \cdot \text{prior}}{\text{marginal likelihood}} = \frac{p(\mathbf{y}|\mathbf{X}, \boldsymbol{\theta}) \cdot q(\boldsymbol{\theta})}{p(\mathbf{y}|\mathbf{X})}$$

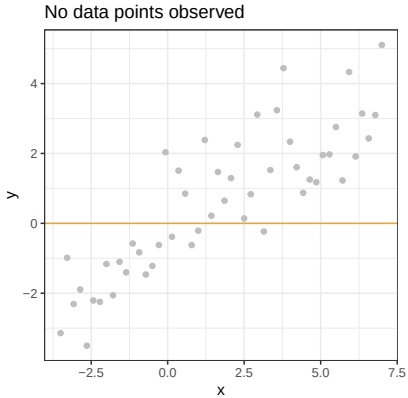
- Gaussian family is "self-conjugate": Gaussian prior & Gaussian likelihood $\Rightarrow$ Gaussian posterior

$$\boldsymbol{\theta} \mid \mathbf{X}, \mathbf{y} \sim \mathcal{N}(\sigma^{-2}\mathbf{K}^{-1}\mathbf{X}^T\mathbf{y}, \mathbf{K}^{-1})$$

with $\mathbf{K} := \sigma^{-2}\mathbf{X}^T\mathbf{X} + \tau^{-2}\boldsymbol{I}_p$

POSTERIOR CONTRACTION





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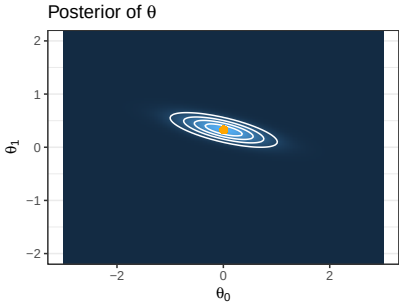

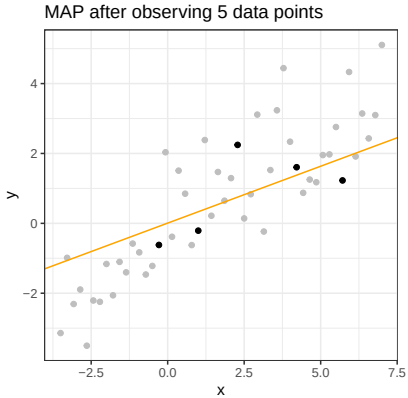

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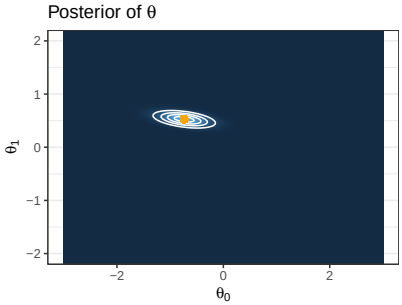

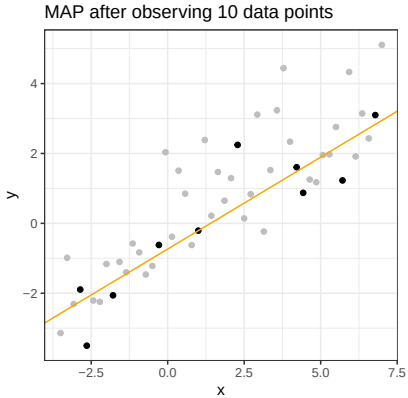

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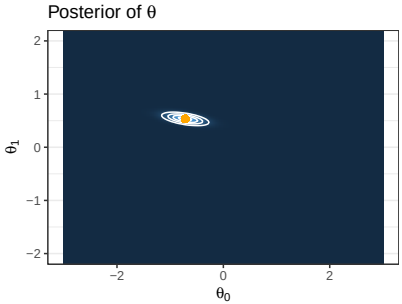
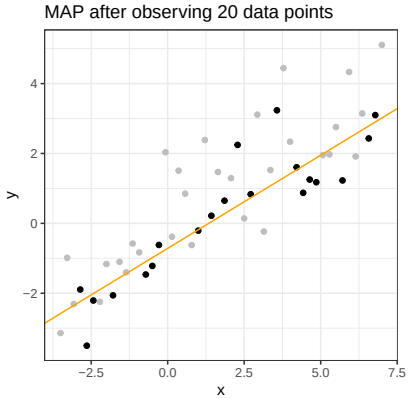




PROOF: GAUSSIANITY OF POSTERIOR

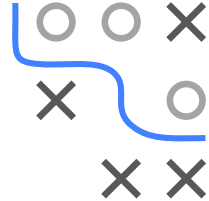
- We want to show that for
  - Gaussian prior $\boldsymbol{\theta} \sim \mathcal{N}(\mathbf{0}, \tau^2 \boldsymbol{I}_p)$ and
  - Gaussian likelihood $\mathbf{y} \mid \mathbf{X}, \boldsymbol{\theta} \sim \mathcal{N}(\mathbf{X}^T\boldsymbol{\theta}, \sigma^2 \boldsymbol{I}_n)$

  the resulting posterior is Gaussian: $\boldsymbol{\theta} \mid \mathbf{X}, \mathbf{y} \sim \mathcal{N}(\sigma^{-2}\mathbf{K}^{-1}\mathbf{X}^T\mathbf{y}, \mathbf{K}^{-1})$
- Plug in Bayes' rule and keep only terms depending on $\boldsymbol{\theta}$

$$
\begin{aligned}
p(\boldsymbol{\theta}|\mathbf{X},\mathbf{y}) &\propto p(\mathbf{y}|\mathbf{X},\boldsymbol{\theta})q(\boldsymbol{\theta}) \quad \propto \quad \exp[-\tfrac{1}{2\sigma^2}(\mathbf{y}-\mathbf{X}\boldsymbol{\theta})^T(\mathbf{y}-\mathbf{X}\boldsymbol{\theta}) - \tfrac{1}{2\tau^2}\boldsymbol{\theta}^T\boldsymbol{\theta}] \\
&= \exp\left[-\tfrac{1}{2}(\sigma^{-2}\mathbf{y}^T\mathbf{y} - 2\sigma^{-2}\mathbf{y}^T\mathbf{X}\boldsymbol{\theta} + \sigma^{-2}\boldsymbol{\theta}^T\mathbf{X}^T\mathbf{X}\boldsymbol{\theta} + \tau^{-2}\boldsymbol{\theta}^T\boldsymbol{\theta})\right] \\
&\propto \exp\left[-\tfrac{1}{2}(\sigma^{-2}\boldsymbol{\theta}^T\mathbf{X}^T\mathbf{X}\boldsymbol{\theta} + \tau^{-2}\boldsymbol{\theta}^T\boldsymbol{\theta} - 2\sigma^{-2}\mathbf{y}^T\mathbf{X}\boldsymbol{\theta})\right] \\
&= \exp\left[-\tfrac{1}{2}\boldsymbol{\theta}^T \underbrace{(\sigma^{-2}\mathbf{X}^T\mathbf{X} + \tau^{-2}\boldsymbol{I}_p)}_{:=\mathbf{K}} \boldsymbol{\theta} + \sigma^{-2}\mathbf{y}^T\mathbf{X}\boldsymbol{\theta}\right]
\end{aligned}
$$

- Note how this resembles a normal density, except for the term in orange
- No need to worry about normalizing constant – sole purpose: ensure density integrates to total prob of 1

PROOF: GAUSSIANITY OF POSTERIOR



- Get rid of nuisance term by introducing complementary terms and compensating for the added quantities ("creative 0")

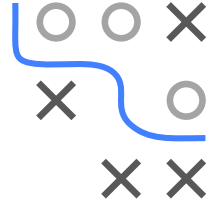
$$
\begin{aligned}
p(\boldsymbol{\theta}|\mathbf{X},\mathbf{y}) &\propto \exp[-\tfrac{1}{2}(\boldsymbol{\theta}-c)^T\mathbf{K}(\boldsymbol{\theta}-c)-c^T\mathbf{K}\boldsymbol{\theta}+\underbrace{\tfrac{1}{2}c^T\mathbf{K}c}_{\text{doesn't depend on }\boldsymbol{\theta}}+\sigma^{-2}\mathbf{y}^T\mathbf{X}\boldsymbol{\theta}] \\
&\propto \exp[-\tfrac{1}{2}(\boldsymbol{\theta}-c)^T\mathbf{K}(\boldsymbol{\theta}-c)-c^T\mathbf{K}\boldsymbol{\theta}+\sigma^{-2}\mathbf{y}^T\mathbf{X}\boldsymbol{\theta}]
\end{aligned}
$$

- Choosing c s.t. $-c^T\mathbf{K}\boldsymbol{\theta}+\sigma^{-2}\mathbf{y}^T\mathbf{X}\boldsymbol{\theta}=0$ leads to $p(\boldsymbol{\theta}|\mathbf{X},\mathbf{y}) \propto \exp[-\tfrac{1}{2}(\boldsymbol{\theta}-c)^T\mathbf{K}(\boldsymbol{\theta}-c)]$
- Using that $\mathbf{K}$ is symmetric, this implies

$$
\begin{aligned}
& \sigma^{-2}\mathbf{y}^T\mathbf{X}=c^T\mathbf{K} \\
\Leftrightarrow\quad & \sigma^{-2}\mathbf{y}^T\mathbf{X}\mathbf{K}^{-1}=c^T \\
\Leftrightarrow\quad & c=\sigma^{-2}\mathbf{K}^{-1}\mathbf{X}^T\mathbf{y}
\end{aligned}
$$

- Finally: $\boldsymbol{\theta} \mid \mathbf{X},\mathbf{y} \sim \mathcal{N}(\sigma^{-2}\mathbf{K}^{-1}\mathbf{X}^T\mathbf{y},\mathbf{K}^{-1}) \quad \square$

POSTERIOR PREDICTIVE DISTRIBUTION



- Based on the posterior

$$\boldsymbol{\theta} \mid \mathbf{X}, \mathbf{y} \sim \mathcal{N}(\sigma^{-2}\mathbf{K}^{-1}\mathbf{X}^T\mathbf{y}, \mathbf{K}^{-1})$$

  we can derive the predictive distribution of the Bayesian LM

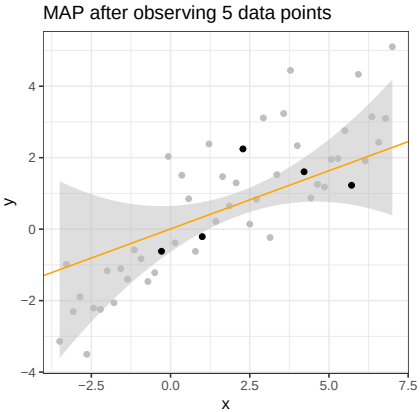
- For a new observation $\mathbf{x}_*$ we get

$$y_* \mid \mathbf{X}, \mathbf{y}, \mathbf{x}_* \sim \mathcal{N}(\sigma^{-2}\mathbf{y}^T\mathbf{X}\mathbf{K}^{-1}\mathbf{x}_*, \mathbf{x}_*^T\mathbf{K}^{-1}\mathbf{x}_*)$$

- NB: entire distribution with built-in confidence

POSTERIOR MEAN AND VARIANCE

- For every test input $\mathbf{x}_*$, we get a posterior mean (orange) & variance (grey region; $\pm 2\times$ standard deviation)



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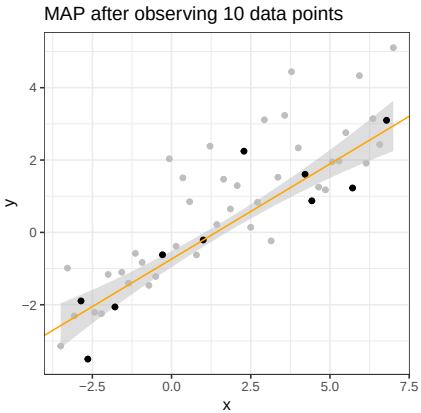

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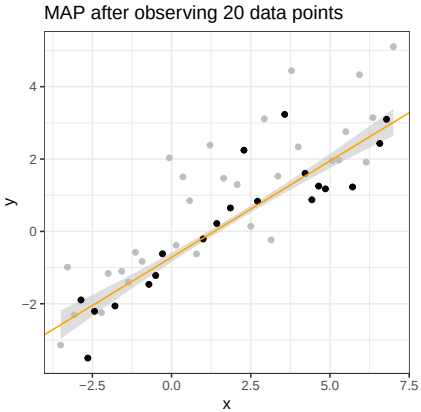

SUMMARY: BAYESIAN LM

- Bayesian perspective: whole distributions, rather than just point estimates, for $\boldsymbol{\theta}$
- From posterior distribution of $\boldsymbol{\theta}$ we can derive a predictive distribution for $y_* = \boldsymbol{\theta}^T \mathbf{x}_*$
- Online updates: after observing new data points, recompute posterior $\Rightarrow$ decreasing uncertainty
- Next up: generalize this idea to nonlinear functions